

SGSITS MUN 2026

10th & 11th October 2026

PROCEDURE FOR MAHABHARAT

GUIDE TO RULES OF PROCEDURE

Committee: Mahabharat

Theme: Uniting Through Dharma

Format: Historical / Character-Based Committee

Agenda: Palace Intrigue, Strategic Diplomacy, Espionage, Succession and the Dynamics
of Court Politics

INTRODUCTION

The SGSITS MUN 2026 Mahabharat Committee presents these Rules of Procedure (ROP) to establish a clear, fair and engaging framework for debate. The procedure combines familiar parliamentary mechanisms with a historical and character-based setting so that delegates can debate political legitimacy, succession, diplomacy, intelligence, alliances, Dharma and Rajadharma within the world of the Mahabharat.

Delegates are expected to understand both the procedure and the responsibilities of their assigned portfolios. Creative interpretation is encouraged, but it must remain consistent with the interests, relationships and political position of the character or portfolio represented.

The Executive Board (EB) shall guide the committee throughout the proceedings. Where these rules do not expressly cover a situation, the EB may make a procedural ruling consistent with fairness, clarity and the spirit of the committee.

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1. GENERAL RULES & AUTHORITY OF THE EB

1.1 Executive Board

- Presiding Authority: The Executive Board (EB) consists of the Chairperson, Vice Chairperson and Rapporteur.
- The Chair shall preside over debate, recognise speakers, entertain motions, maintain decorum and interpret the ROP.
- The Vice Chairperson may assist the Chair and exercise the Chair's procedural authority when directed to do so.
- The Rapporteur shall assist with attendance, documentation, written submissions and other committee administration.
- The EB may make a procedural ruling where a situation is not expressly covered by these rules. Such a ruling shall be consistent with fairness and the spirit of the committee.

1.2 Recognition & Speaking

- A delegate may speak only after being recognised by the Chair.
- No delegate shall interrupt another delegate except through a point specifically permitted to interrupt under these rules.
- The Chair may interrupt a speech that is irrelevant, excessively repetitive, personally offensive or contrary to committee procedure.

1.3 Decorum

- Delegates shall address one another through their assigned portfolios/characters where appropriate.
- Personal attacks, insults, shouting, deliberate disruption and disrespect toward the EB are prohibited.
- Delegates may portray political hostility between historical figures, but the interaction must remain within acceptable committee decorum.

1.4 Written Communication

- Chits may be used for questions, requests, negotiations and diplomatic communication where permitted by the EB.
- The EB may inspect, regulate, delay or stop chit circulation whenever required.

1.5 Relevance & Historical Setting

- Debate should remain connected to the agenda and the political world of the Mahabharat.
- Creative interpretation is permitted, but delegates should remain consistent with their portfolio's interests, relationships and position.

2. POINTS, MOTIONS & PROCEDURAL PRECEDENCE

2.1 Points

- **Point of Personal Privilege:** Used for a personal or practical difficulty affecting participation, such as inability to hear the speaker.
- **Point of Order:** Used when a delegate believes a procedural rule is being incorrectly followed.
- **Point of Parliamentary Inquiry:** Used to ask the EB about the procedure currently being followed.
- **Point of Information:** Used, where permitted, to ask a relevant question to a speaker. It should not become a second speech.

2.2 Motions

- A motion is a formal proposal asking the committee to change the mode of debate or take a procedural step.
- Motions may be raised when the Chair opens the floor for motions.
- A motion should clearly state the intended action and relevant time limits.

2.3 Procedural Precedence

- The Chair may prioritise motions according to relevance, practicality and the current state of debate.
- The Chair may rule a motion out of order if it is vague, repetitive, dilatory or unrelated to the agenda.
- Where multiple caucus motions are proposed, the Chair may decide the order in which they are considered.

2.4 Common Motions

Motion	Purpose	Suggested Standard
Moderated Caucus	Focused discussion on a defined sub-topic.	Majority
Unmoderated Caucus	Informal negotiation and drafting.	Majority
Extend Caucus	Continue the current caucus.	Majority
Close Debate	End substantive discussion and move to voting.	As determined by EB
Adjourn Committee	End the sitting/session when called for.	As determined by EB

3. OPENING OF COMMITTEE & FORMAL DEBATE

3.1 Roll Call

- The Rapporteur shall conduct roll call at the beginning of a session. Delegates shall respond when their portfolio is called.
- The EB may establish quorum before substantive debate begins.

3.2 EB Briefing

- The Chair shall explain the agenda, committee setting, expectations and essential rules before formal debate.
- Delegates may ask procedural questions before substantive debate begins.

3.3 Opening Statements

- The Chair may invite opening statements to establish the broad position of each portfolio.
- An opening statement should identify the portfolio's interests, concerns and preferred direction rather than merely narrating background information.

3.4 Formal Debate

- Formal debate is conducted through recognised speakers.
- Delegates should remain relevant to the agenda and may discuss Dharma, succession, political legitimacy, alliances, intelligence, court influence, diplomacy and military considerations where relevant.
- The Chair may request a delegate to conclude if the allotted speaking time has expired.

3.5 Speaking Time

- The Chair may establish a default speaking time or accept a motion concerning speaking time.
- Speaking time may be changed during the committee if the EB considers it necessary for balanced participation.

3.6 General Parliamentary Principle

The committee shall prioritise orderly debate, meaningful participation and substantive political negotiation. Procedure exists to facilitate debate, not to prevent legitimate discussion.

4. SPEAKERS' LIST, SPEECHES & YIELDS

4.1 Speakers' List

- The Speakers' List (GSL) is the principal formal debate format.
- Delegates may be added to the list when the Chair opens it.
- The list may be interrupted by an approved caucus or procedural motion and resumed afterwards.

4.2 Recommended Speech Structure

Stage	Purpose
Position	State what the portfolio believes or wants.
Reasoning	Explain political, strategic or moral justification.
Proposal	Offer a realistic course of action.
Diplomatic Close	Invite cooperation or state conditions for support.

4.3 Yields

- Yield to the Chair/EB: Ends the speech.
- Yield to another delegate: Transfers remaining time if the Chair permits it.
- Yield to questions: Allows questions where the Chair has authorised them.
- No yield shall be made during a moderated caucus unless the Chair expressly allows it.

4.4 Questions & Points of Information

- Questions should be concise, relevant and genuinely interrogative.
- The Chair may reject a question that is argumentative, repetitive, insulting or unrelated to the speech.

4.5 Speaking Etiquette

- Avoid reading long prepared text when a concise argument would be more effective.
- Address the issue, not the person. Strong disagreement is permitted; personal disrespect is not.

5. MODERATED CAUCUS

5.1 Purpose

A moderated caucus is an informal but Chair-controlled debate used to examine a defined sub-topic through a series of focused, time-limited speeches.

5.2 Motion Format

- A valid motion should specify the topic, total duration and individual speaking time.
- The Chair may reject a proposed caucus that is excessively broad, repetitive, dilatory or unrelated to the agenda.

5.3 During the Caucus

- The Chair recognises speakers one by one.
- Delegates should focus specifically on the announced sub-topic.
- No yields are made unless the Chair expressly permits them.
- The Chair may end a caucus early if discussion becomes repetitive or unproductive.

5.4 Extension

- A delegate may move to extend a caucus if further discussion is necessary.
- The Chair may limit or reject an extension where it would unnecessarily delay committee progress.

5.5 Suggested Mahabharat Sub-Topics

- Legitimacy of succession and competing claims to rule.
- The role of elders, advisers and the Sabha in political decisions.
- Alliances and obligations between kingdoms.
- Espionage, intelligence and counter-intelligence.
- Rajadharma versus personal loyalty.
- Diplomatic settlements, military preparedness and the political cost of escalation.

6. UNMODERATED CAUCUS & INFORMAL NEGOTIATION

6.1 Purpose

An unmoderated caucus is an informal session in which delegates may move, negotiate, form alliances and work on written proposals. It is intended to convert debate into practical political agreements.

6.2 Motion Format

- The Chair may ask the proposer to state the purpose and duration.

6.3 Negotiation

- Delegates may form alliances around shared interests without giving up their independent identity or portfolio.
- Delegates may negotiate support, conditions, information-sharing, diplomatic commitments and wording of proposals.
- A delegate may support one provision while disagreeing with another.

6.4 Chits During Negotiation

- Chits may be used to communicate discreetly where allowed by the EB.
- Delegates should not use written communication to bypass the authority of the EB or disrupt the committee.

6.5 Returning to Formal Debate

- When the Chair calls the committee back to order, delegates must return to their seats and cease private negotiation.
- The Chair may ask a delegate to report the outcome of negotiations if it is relevant to the next stage of debate.

7. DRAFTING & PRASTAV PATRA

7.1 What is Drafting?

Drafting is the process through which delegates convert debate, negotiation and political commitments into a coherent written proposal for consideration by the committee.

7.2 Karya Patra

- A Karya Patra is an informal collection of ideas. It may be incomplete and can be changed freely during
- It may include possible solutions, arguments, commitments, alliances and proposed clauses.

7.3 Prastav Patra

- The Prastav Patra should convert discussion into specific, actionable and logically connected provisions.
- It should be written in clear language and remain consistent with the historical-political setting of the committee.
- It may address matters such as succession, governance, alliances, diplomatic missions, intelligence, obligations between kingdoms, military preparedness, settlement mechanisms or other agenda-relevant issues.

7.4 Karya Patra vs Prastav Patra

Karya Patra	Prastav Patra
Informal and flexible.	Formalised negotiated proposal.
Can contain rough ideas.	Should contain clear provisions.
May be incomplete.	Should present a coherent solution.
Used mainly during negotiation.	Submitted for formal consideration.

7.5 Personal Directive (Gupta Patra)

- A Gupta Patra is a confidential written directive submitted privately by a delegate to the EB.
- It may contain covert diplomatic instructions, intelligence-gathering, negotiations, private alliances, requests or actions that fall within the authority of the represented portfolio.
- The directive must be relevant to the agenda and consistent with the character's political interests, relationships, powers and responsibilities in the Mahabharat setting.
- The EB may approve, modify, reject or seek clarification on a Gupta Patra before execution.
- A Gupta Patra is not a substitute for a Prastav Patra and does not automatically bind the committee.
- The EB shall maintain confidentiality and may disclose outcomes only to the extent necessary for committee proceedings.

8. PRASTAV PATRA: FORMAT, SUBMISSION & INTRODUCTION

8.1 Suggested Format

Part	What to Include
Title	Short title identifying the issue/proposal.
Preamble / Context	Why the issue requires attention; relevant principles, concerns or circumstances.
Operative Provisions	Specific actions, decisions, mechanisms or commitments.
Implementation	Who carries out the action and how it will operate.
Safeguards	Conditions, limitations or checks where required.
Signatories	Delegates willing to support the proposal's discussion.

8.2 Preamble / Context

- The context should establish the political problem without becoming a long narrative.
- It may refer to Dharma, Rajadharma, stability of the realm, succession, diplomatic obligations, security or other relevant principles.

8.3 Operative Provisions

- Each operative provision should state a clear action or decision.
- Avoid vague language such as “will solve the problem” without explaining how.
- Where possible, specify the responsible authority, expected action and intended result.

8.4 Sponsors & Signatories

- The EB may prescribe the minimum number required for submission.
- Sponsors: Delegates who actively support and have helped formulate the proposal.
- Signatories: Delegates who wish the proposal to be discussed; signing does not necessarily mean full support.

8.5 Submission

- The Prastav Patra shall be submitted to the EB in the format and by the method announced by the Chair.
- The EB may return a draft for correction of relevance, clarity, formatting or procedural compliance before introduction.

8.6 Personal Directive (Gupta Patra)

- Submit the Gupta Patra privately to the EB in the prescribed format.
- Clearly state the intended action, objective and portfolio authority involved.
- The directive should be specific, feasible and consistent with the Mahabharat setting.
- The EB shall determine whether and how the directive is executed and may communicate its outcome during proceedings.

9. AMENDMENTS & DISCUSSION OF PROPOSALS

9.1 Purpose of an Amendment

- An amendment must be relevant to the provision being changed and should not introduce an entirely unrelated issue.

9.2 Types of Amendments

- **Add:** Insert a word, phrase, clause or provision.
- **Remove:** Delete existing wording.
- **Replace:** Substitute existing wording with new language.
- **Alter:** Modify wording while retaining the basic purpose.

9.3 Friendly & Unfriendly Amendments

- **Friendly Amendment:** An amendment accepted by the relevant sponsors, where the committee's procedure allows it to be incorporated without a separate substantive vote.
- **Unfriendly Amendment:** An amendment not accepted by the relevant sponsors and therefore put through the voting procedure prescribed by the EB.

9.4 Scope

- The amendment must be relevant to the proposal and within its scope.
- The Chair may reject an amendment that is frivolous, contradictory, irrelevant or designed merely to obstruct.

9.5 Discussion

- The Chair may allow speakers for and against an amendment.
- The committee may enter a moderated or unmoderated caucus to negotiate wording if permitted.
- Once discussion is sufficiently complete, the Chair shall put the amendment to vote.

9.6 Amendment to an Amendment

- A further amendment may be considered only where the Chair determines that it is procedurally appropriate and sufficiently connected to the amendment under consideration.

10. VOTING, RECONSIDERATION & WITHDRAWAL

10.1 Closure of Debate

- When the Chair considers discussion sufficiently complete, a delegate may move to close debate, subject to the applicable procedure and the Chair's discretion.
- The Chair may require the committee to hear a final speaker or speakers before voting.

10.2 Voting

- Once debate is closed, the Chair shall clearly state the question being put to vote.
- Delegates shall vote according to the method announced by the EB.
- Unless a different threshold is specifically prescribed by the EB, ordinary procedural motions shall generally be decided by a simple majority of delegates present and voting.
- The EB shall clarify any special majority required before the relevant vote.

10.3 Methods of Voting

- Placard Vote: Delegates raise placards when instructed.
- Roll-Call Vote: Portfolios are called individually and respond with the option announced by the Chair.
- The Chair may choose the voting method appropriate to the matter before the committee.

10.4 Withdrawal of a Proposal

- A sponsor may request withdrawal of a proposal before the final vote, subject to the Chair's permission and any applicable committee procedure.
- The Chair may ask whether another group wishes to continue with a substantially similar proposal.

10.5 Reconsideration

- A decision may be reconsidered only when the Chair permits such a motion and determines that reconsideration is procedurally appropriate.
- Reconsideration should not be used simply to delay proceedings.

10.6 Finality

- Once the committee has reached a final decision on a matter, the EB shall record the result and move the committee to the next stage of business.

11. MAHABHARAT-SPECIFIC FRAMEWORK & QUICK REFERENCE

11.1 Portfolio Representation

- Delegates should represent the political interests, relationships and responsibilities of their assigned characters/portfolios.
- A delegate may evolve their position during negotiation; changing a position through diplomacy is a legitimate part of the committee.

11.2 Dharma & Rajadharma

- Dharma may be used as a moral and political framework for arguments, but delegates should explain how their interpretation applies to the specific issue.
- Rajadharma may be invoked when discussing the duties of rulers, governance, justice, stability and responsibility toward the realm.

11.3 Court Politics & Diplomacy

- The committee may involve succession disputes, influence of advisers and elders, alliances, royal obligations, diplomacy, intelligence and competing political interests.
- Delegates should distinguish between personal loyalty and state/kingdom interests where relevant.

11.4 Quick Motion Guide

Situation	Suggested Wording / Action
Moderated Caucus	"Motion for a moderated caucus on ____ for ____ minutes, with ____ seconds per speaker."
Unmoderated Caucus	"Motion for an unmoderated caucus of ____ minutes for the purpose of ____."
Point of Order	"Point of Order." Then briefly identify the procedural issue.
Parliamentary Inquiry	"Point of Parliamentary Inquiry." Ask the EB about procedure.
Close Debate	"Motion to close debate and move to voting."
Prastav Patra	Prepare → negotiate → submit to EB → introduce → discuss → amend if required → vote.
Gupta Patra	Submit privately to EB · state objective/action · EB reviews · approved action may be executed confidentially.

FINAL NOTE

The objective of this procedure is to create a structured yet immersive political forum. Delegates are expected to use procedure to facilitate meaningful debate, negotiation and consensus while remaining faithful to their assigned portfolios and the Mahabharat setting.

ANNEXURE 1

SAMPLE PRASTAV PATRA STRUCTURE

Title: [Short title of the proposal]

Context / Preamble:

- State the political problem or concern.
- Identify the relevant principles, circumstances or interests.
- Explain why the committee should address the issue.

Operative Provisions:

- Provision 1 — Clearly state the action or decision.
- Provision 2 — Identify the authority/party responsible.
- Provision 3 — Explain implementation or coordination.
- Provision 4 — Add safeguards, conditions or review mechanisms where required.

Signatories: [Names/Portfolios as prescribed by the EB]

DRAFTING CHECKLIST

- Is the proposal directly connected to the agenda?
- Does every operative provision describe a concrete action or decision?
- Is the proposal consistent with the Mahabharat political setting?
- Are responsibility and implementation reasonably clear?
- Does the proposal avoid vague or purely rhetorical language?
- Has the proposal been submitted to the EB in the prescribed format?
- Have sponsors and signatories been identified as required by the EB?

ANNEXURE 3

SAMPLE PERSONAL DIRECTIVE · GUPTA PATRA

Portfolio: [Character / Kingdom]

Objective: [State the private objective clearly]

Directive: [State the action, negotiation, intelligence request or diplomatic instruction]

Reason / Context: [Briefly explain why the action serves the portfolio's interests]

Expected Outcome: [State the desired result]

Note: The Gupta Patra is confidential and remains subject to EB approval.

ANNEXURE 2

PROCEDURAL FLOW — QUICK REFERENCE

Stage	What Happens
1. Roll Call	Rapporteur calls portfolios; EB may establish quorum.
2. EB Briefing	Agenda, setting, expectations and essential rules are explained.
3. Opening Statements	Portfolios establish broad political positions.
4. Formal Debate / GSL	Delegates present positions, reasoning and proposals.
5. Moderated Caucus	Focused discussion on defined sub-topics.
6. Unmoderated Caucus	Negotiation, alliance-building and drafting.
7. Karya Patra	Informal ideas are consolidated for negotiation.
8. Gupta Patra	Confidential instructions submitted privately to the EB for review and execution.
9. Prastav Patra	Negotiated ideas become a formal proposal.
10. Submission	Proposal is submitted to the EB for review.
11. Introduction	Approved proposal is introduced to the committee.
12. Discussion & Amendments	Delegates debate and modify provisions where permitted.
13. Voting	Committee votes according to the method and threshold announced by the EB.
14. Final Decision	EB records the outcome and moves to the next stage.

END OF RULES OF PROCEDURE